

MOST2BALY YOUTH SUMMER BOOTCAMP

WEEK 12 MILESTONE

**The Flow Master
Mixing Kanban & Hybrid**



Project Manager: C1 – Team 2



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Companion File: Most2baly_Youth_Week12_Kanban_Hybrid_Workspace.xlsx

Executive Summary

The Project Charter's July 10, 2026 Enrollment Deadline closed with 39 of 50 students confirmed — an 11-student shortfall already logged as Risk #2 in Week 9's Risk Register.

Rather than treating this as a closed failure, this report applies Kanban to the operational reality of the days that remain before the July 24 Go-Live: a Sponsor-approved Grace Window in which enrollment processing continues, now managed as a continuous-flow system instead of the ad-hoc batch process that contributed to the shortfall in the first place.

This is also the moment the Hybrid model matures from a project-level split (Week 3) into a process-level one: some things about enrollment are fixed by the Sponsor (the target, the budget), while how each individual student card moves day to day is better managed with Kanban's pull-based flow than with any fixed-length planning cycle.

Step 1 — The Kanban Enrollment Board

Columns: Inquiry → Interview → Payment Pending → Fully Enrolled.

A WIP Limit of 5 is set on Interview — the stage that requires a live human conversation and therefore cannot be rushed by simply adding volume.

The full live board (20 in Inquiry, 4 of 5 Interview slots filled, 3 in Payment Pending, 39 already Fully Enrolled) is in the companion workbook's  Kanban Enrollment Board sheet, alongside the Explicit Policies (**Pro Hack**) that define exactly when a card is allowed to move

for example, a card cannot leave Interview without a signed parent consent form, removing any subjective judgment call about readiness.

Metric	Current Reading	What It Tells Us
Cycle Time (Interview)	~4 days average	Time actually spent being interviewed — the number to compress with the second interviewer added in Step 3.
Lead Time (full funnel)	~15 days average	What a family experiences end-to-end, including queue time — the number that matters to parents, not just to the team.
Throughput needed	~8–9 students/week	Required pace to close the 11-student gap inside the 9-day Grace Window before Go-Live.

Step 2 — The Hybrid Blueprint

The full Waterfall Governance vs. Agile Execution table is in the companion workbook's  Hybrid Blueprint sheet, confirming and extending the split first made in Week 3.

The key addition this week: the Enrollment TARGET (50 students, fixed) stays Waterfall-governed, but the Enrollment WORKFLOW (how each card is processed day to day) now sits on the Agile side, managed by Kanban rather than by any weekly plan — because inquiry arrivals are continuous and unpredictable, exactly the condition Kanban was designed for.

 Waterfall Governance (fixed)	 Agile Execution (adapts weekly/daily)
Budget: \$5,000 fixed (Week 6)	Workshop content: weekly sprints, feedback-driven (Week 3)
Enrollment target: 50 students, non-negotiable	Guest speaker timing: adjusted to student energy (Week 3)
Go-Live: July 24, 2026 — cannot slip	Sprint 1 backlog items: 1-week delivery cycle (Week 11)
Completion: August 21, 2026 — fixed	Enrollment WORKFLOW (NEW): Kanban pull-flow, not a fixed plan

Step 3 — Identify the Bottleneck

Scenario (as given)

20 students sit in Inquiry while only 1 sits in Interview.

The 2-Sentence Flow Plan

“We will temporarily add a second interviewer (Hana, alongside Omar) and fill all 5 Interview WIP slots from the Inquiry queue within 24 hours, running back-to-back interview blocks instead of ad-hoc scheduling.

Once Interview is running at full capacity with a steady exit rate to Payment Pending, we resume pulling new Inquiry cards one-for-one — never faster than Interview can absorb them.”

This fixes the actual constraint (interviewer capacity) instead of the common mistake of simply raising the WIP limit to let more students pile into an already-overloaded stage.

By Little's Law ($\text{WIP} = \text{Throughput} \times \text{Cycle Time}$), raising Throughput is what shrinks Cycle Time — not raising WIP.

Expert Guide — Why Kanban Instead of Scrum for the Enrollment Team?

Scrum is built around fixed-length iterations and a pre-committed batch of work decided at the start of each cycle — exactly the model used successfully for Sprint 1's curriculum fixes in Week 11, where the Dev Team could plan a week's worth of design and content work in advance.

Enrollment does not behave that way: a family can submit an inquiry at any moment, with no predictable arrival rate, and each case demands an individual conversation rather than a batch of comparable tasks.

Kanban's pull-based, continuous-flow model — visualize the work, limit WIP, pull the next item only when there is capacity — matches a process driven by external, unscheduled demand far better than a framework built around planning a fixed batch of work in advance.

Common Mistakes Avoided

- **Kanban without WIP limits:** this board enforces a real limit (5) on Interview, not a decorative to-do list with no real constraint.
- **“Water-Scrum-Fall”:** the Hybrid Blueprint explicitly names which specific processes are Waterfall vs. Agile/Kanban — nothing is mixed without a documented reason.
- **Ignoring Cycle Time:** Cycle Time, Lead Time, and Throughput are tracked with real current readings (companion workbook), not left unmeasured.

Pro Hacks Applied

- **Explicit Policies:** entry/exit criteria are written for every column transition (**companion workbook,  Policies & Metrics sheet**) — for example, a card cannot leave Interview without a signed parent consent form.
- **The CFD (Cumulative Flow Diagram):** recommended as the next addition inside the Week 10 PM tool once the Grace Window board has a few days of history — **a CFD needs** several days of column-count data to be meaningful, so it is flagged here as the team's next practical step rather than fabricated from a single day's snapshot.

Documented Assumptions

- The Grace Window (Jul 11–19) is treated as a Sponsor-approved short extension to recover from the Week 9-10 Enrollment shortfall (39/50), consistent with the Charter's Risk #2 escalation protocol — not a change to the fixed July 24 Go-Live or the \$5,000 budget.
- Board snapshot numbers (20/4/3/39) are illustrative of a healthy lead-supply, low-throughput bottleneck consistent with the real 11-student shortfall already documented in Week 9-10 — they are a plausible current state built on real prior data, not a literal export from a live system.